

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Constitutional root and the operating chain

ROOT QUESTION

How does parliamentary executive authority become organised governmental action?

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+-- ARTICLES 73 + 74 --+-- Union executive field and ministerial advice
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|      +-- political authority remains Constitution-bounded
+-- ARTICLE 77 -----+-- action in President's name and authentication
|
|      +-- Article 77(3) business-allocation and transaction rules
+-- ARTICLE 78 ----- PM communication and information duties to President
|
|      v
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Ministerial direction -> Secretariat advice/process -> agency delivery -> accountability.

MUST REMEMBER: Separate Articles 73-78, Allocation of Business jurisdiction, Transaction of Business procedure and each body's own statutory source.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: AoB and ToB: jurisdiction before procedure

ARTICLE 77(3)

+-----+-----+

v

v

ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES

TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES

who handles what

how a proposal is decided

ministry/department + subjects

disposal + consultation + escalation

+-----+-----+

v

lawful owner + lawful decision route

TRAP RAIL

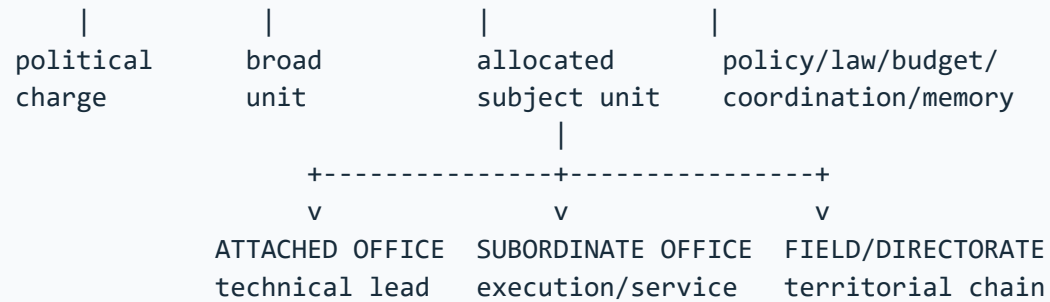
AoB != ToB | both != Article 309 | schedule can change | statute still controls.

ANSWER STRIP

Allocation supplies jurisdiction; transaction supplies procedure and collective discipline.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Institution map: political head to field delivery

PORTFOLIO -> MINISTRY -> DEPARTMENT -> SECRETARIAT



SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS

statutory body | autonomous body | CPSE | regulator.

TRAP

administrative association does not erase the source instrument or statutory independence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Minister, Minister of State and Secretary

POLITICAL EXECUTIVE

Cabinet Minister -> portfolio leadership, Cabinet participation, Parliament.

Minister of State -> independent charge or assigned assistance, as formally allocated.

PERMANENT EXECUTIVE

Secretary -> administrative head + principal official adviser + transaction compliance.

PRODUCTIVE RELATION

elected priority -> candid options/legality -> recorded decision -> loyal implementation.

FAILURE BRANCHES

politicised advice | bureaucratic veto | oral direction | short tenure | hidden responsibility.

ANSWER STRIP

Responsive neutrality joins lawful democratic control to professional institutional memory.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Central Secretariat functions and file process

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT

policy | legislation/rules | budget | Parliament | coordination | monitoring | records.

FILE RAIL

receipt -> section examination -> facts/law/finance -> noting/options
-> inter-department consultation -> delegated or higher approval
-> authentication/issue -> implementation -> monitoring/audit/RTI.

HIERARCHY

Section Officer -> Under Secretary -> Deputy Secretary/Director
-> Joint Secretary -> Additional/Special Secretary -> Secretary.

TRAP

not every file reaches Minister/Secretary; delegation is an accountability design, not evasion.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Secretariat hierarchy and delegated file disposal

SECRETARY -> SPECIAL/ADDITIONAL SECRETARY -> JOINT SECRETARY
-> DIRECTOR/DEPUTY SECRETARY -> UNDER SECRETARY -> SECTION.

FILE

receipt -> examination/noting -> consultation -> competent approval
-> issue/authentication -> record/monitoring.

RULE

lowest competent delegated level; authority and reasons remain traceable.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Keep the Central Secretariat, Cabinet Secretariat, PMO, ministries, departments, attached offices and delivery bodies institutionally distinct.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Cabinet Secretariat, PMO and coordination

CABINET SECRETARIAT

Cabinet papers/decisions | AoB-ToB administration | CoS | crisis and consensus.

PMO

direct assistance to Prime Minister | priority review | matters requiring PM attention.

UNRESOLVED DIFFERENCE

department consultation -> Committee of Secretaries -> concerned ministers
-> Cabinet Committee/Cabinet under the prescribed route.

BOUNDARY

Cabinet Secretariat != Cabinet | PMO != super-ministry | Cabinet Secretary != minister.

ANSWER STRIP

Central coordination should enable departments without erasing ministerial answerability.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Agencies, autonomy and whole-of-government outcomes

DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER

- +-- attached/subordinate office -> technical/field execution
- +-- autonomous body -> chartered special function
- +-- CPSE -> commercial/strategic operation
- +-- regulator -> statute-based arm's-length governance

WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM

climate/data/skills/water -> many departments -> silo optimisation -> outcome failure.

CORRECTIVE

named lead + shared milestones/data + funds/functionaries + State/field feedback.

LIMIT

mission unit or dashboard cannot displace statute, sanction, Cabinet route or audit.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Cabinet committees and inter-ministerial resolution

CABINET / CABINET COMMITTEE
political collective decision.

COMMITTEE OF SECRETARIES
administrative coordination and common advice.

CABINET SECRETARIAT
procedure, agenda, records, monitoring and consensus.

PMO
support to PM; not Cabinet-record custodian or super-ministry.

ESCALATE unresolved cross-government conflict, not every routine file.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Oversight, reform and notification-sensitive change

ACCOUNTABILITY GRID

Parliament/questions/DRSCs -> political and policy scrutiny.

budget/demands/CAG/PAC -> financial legality, propriety and performance.

RTI/courts/vigilance -> transparency, legality and personal responsibility.

REFORM

2nd ARC principles | delegation | competency-to-post fit | Mission Karmayogi

| digital record | impact evaluation | stable tenure | specialist/lateral support.

REORGANISATION

Article 77(3) rule change -> cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition.

TRAP

renamed organogram != improved outcome; ministry/committee counts must be dated.

CURRENT SNAPSHOT: 5 SEPTEMBER 2026

The 27 April 2026 Cabinet Secretariat directory identifies T. V.

Somanathan as Cabinet Secretary. Ministry/department counts and portfolio labels remain notification-sensitive and are not frozen.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Verified PYQs and answer execution

2025 PRELIMS Q57: organisation-ministry pairs -> NONE.

2020 GS-II Q7: institutional quality -> civil-service + departmental reform.

2020 GS-II Q8: digital revolution -> lawful integrated e-governance.

2024 GS-II Q3: cabinet growth -> practical parliamentary marginalisation.

ANSWER

constitutional source -> organisation -> mechanism -> accountability -> reform.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: UPSC synthesis: organised authority with traceable responsibility

PRELIMS FIREWALL

AoB=owner | ToB=route | President's name != personal decision
| Secretariat != Cabinet Secretariat | Cabinet Committee != Committee of Secretaries
| attached office != autonomous body | regulator autonomy survives ordinary instruction.

MAINS SPINE

Articles 73/74/77/78 -> AoB-ToB -> ministry/department
-> Minister-Secretary -> Secretariat/file -> coordination
-> agencies/outcomes -> oversight -> reform.

PYQ SPINE

2025 organisation-ministry pairs -> verify allocated subject and parent law.

VERDICT

effective machinery aligns functions, funds, functionaries, expertise and answerability.

LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: The 27 April 2026 Cabinet Secretariat directory identifies T. V.

Somanathan as Cabinet Secretary; ministry and department counts are not frozen.